

Table 1
Roles of systems, providers, counselors or direct service professionals, and individuals that support informed choice

Objective	Role of the system	Role of provider	Role of counselors and direct service professionals	Role of individual
Individual is the focal point, the driving force, and the decision maker	-Has a unified vision of preferred employment outcomes and informed choice across payers, providers, and DSPs and choice -Informs individuals of their role and responsibilities -Funds individuals not programs -System ensures that individuals are able to understand their choice and communicate their preferences:	-Committed to informed choice -Relinquishes power in favor of the consumer. -Recognizes the need to make the client happy -Solicits input/feedback from the client about services	-Has expertise but relinquishes power to the individual -Facilitates the individual's ability to identify their own preferences -Makes appropriate accommodations to support the individual's meaningful participation in meetings and other aspects of the decision-making process	-Directs the Person Centered Planning process -Chooses who will be involved in which decisions -Makes choices known with necessary support
Individual has information, knowledge, and experience	-Ensures that each individual has access to information including opportunity to experience alternatives	-Uses discovery to help person see the options, develop preferences, and articulate the choice -Sets up trial work opportunities -Participates in the process where individual chooses provider	-Ensures that the individual understands the options by (1) creating experiential opportunities and (2) uses appropriate modes of communication and other support services	-Shares hopes, dreams and aspirations with the support necessary to do so.
Individual has appropriate supports to facilitate choice		-Invests the process of helping people to understand their options and moving further along the continuum of independently making decisions.	-Identifies and addresses barriers that might interfere with the individual's ability to make an informed choice -Teaches self-determination -Looks closely at a person's life for indicators of preference	-Identifies trusted people to assist with decision-making
Individual has meaningful choice among multiple options and can create new options	-Funds are assigned to people rather than programs -The system has a range of service options from traditional and non-traditional providers -System has allocated funds in such a way as to ensure there is adequate capacity to accommodate individual's choice. -Funds from multiple agencies are seamlessly integrated to fund services for each individual -Funding mechanism reflects policy priorities	-Is flexible in the type of services it provides -Honors the preferences of the person	-Creatively looking at options—expertise -Find or design new possibilities based on individual's dreams desires and experience	-Identifies non-negotiables -Actively participates -Experiences multiple options based on preferences, skills and capacities. -Has a trusted person (navigator) to support you to express your concerns, issues and worries.

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Objective	Role of the system	Role of provider	Role of counselors and Direct service Professionals	Role of individual
Individual has right to choose people to support them		-Uses family members, support system and expertise of the provider appropriately without pressure	-Encourages and values the input from others.	-Chooses people to help make decisions
Individual has the right to leave one provider and be served by another	-Funding is tied to individual rather than a program so the money moves with the individual to another provider	-Support Coordinators solicits person's wish and desire and facilitates changes when necessary		-Exercises right for provider choice, right to leave one provider and be served by another
Individual receives ongoing advice and support and opportunity to modify choice	-System to reassess the placement at will or periodically			-Exercises right to make choices
Individual has control of resources, selecting providers, targeting information and deciding what is relevant	-The funding mechanism gives the individual a maximum amount of control while maintaining accountability and responsible stewardship of public funds -Providers are accountable to the individual rather than the system by having a funding relationship between the individual and the provider -Funding level is tied to individual needs	-Participates in the process where the individual chooses the provider. -Funding relationship exists between the service recipient and the provider -Provides opportunities for the individual to control funding.		-Exercises autonomy and control. Focuses on most important pressing needs
Individual is free of undue pressure	-Conflict free independent Support Coordination/case management	-Is responsive to the person's desires and overcoming the status quo. Safeguarding against staff convenience	-Starts all planning and interactions with an agenda that is free from system and program assumptions	-Exercises autonomy and control
Individual has control—Is empowered to make decisions	-Conflict free independent Support Coordination/case management -Safeguards against exploitation and retaliation	-Invests in the process of helping people to understand their options, independently making decisions and taking pride for those decisions	-Supports the job seeker to make decisions, even those that might not be the ones you might have made for the person	-Exercises autonomy and control
Other issues that need to be discussed but are not directly tied to the definition	-Has developed resources, tools and support services needed by individuals, their families, providers and DSPs to support and facilitate informed choice -The system includes safeguards to promote informed choice. -Has relevant performance measures.	-Credential and certification issues		-Have the right to change their mind and exercise dignity of risk.